

Jack Tinsley

Business Development / Commercial Graduate Roles

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Quietly efficient, commercially curious, and strongest in ambiguous environments. Final-year LIS student who works by understanding how a messy system actually works, finding the leverage point, and turning it into a practical next step. Background combines interdisciplinary research, finance exposure, marketplace selling, hands-on repair work and high-pressure hospitality training. Seeking business development or commercial graduate roles where insight, judgement and relationship-building translate into growth.

HOW I CREATE VALUE

- Spot value - Compare prices, incentives and arbitrage options quickly; identify what is mispriced, wasted or underused.
- Simplify messy systems - Break ill-defined problems into drivers, trade-offs and next actions using systems thinking and practical judgement.
- Build trust and momentum - Adapt communication to people's confidence, motivation and blockers; make the next step easier for others.

COMMERCIAL EXPERIENCE & INITIATIVE

Independent Commercial Projects - Marketplace Selling, Sourcing & Practical Work | Ongoing

- Generated approximately £6,000 in revenue over several years through sourcing, pricing, and selling aquarium plants (and later high-demand variegated Monstera) across eBay, Vinted, Facebook Marketplace and auction platforms, demonstrating pricing judgement, market timing and adaptability to shifting consumer demand.
- Regularly identified mispriced or underused assets for friends and family by comparing second-hand, auction and retail options, balancing price, quality, depreciation and liquidity.
- Completed varied repair, upcycling, landscaping and small construction projects within tight budget, time and material constraints.

Buddy Trainer | Nando's UK | Part-time | 2018-2024

- Trained numerous new starters and existing team members across all restaurant stations, plus delivered cross-training and menu-change training sessions, adapting style to different learning needs and confidence levels.
- Contributed to operational improvements in a high-pressure environment; the restaurant achieved #1 KPI performance in the company for a 6-month period and remained consistently in the top 20 for the final 2 years of my tenure.
- Developed strong situational awareness, prioritisation, customer handling and calm decision-making under pressure.

Finance Intern | MTR Elizabeth Line | London | Summer 2022 (3 months)

- Supported the finance team on operational budgeting, invoice reconciliation and Excel-based reporting processes within a major UK infrastructure programme.
- Produced a slideshow presentation for internal stakeholders, synthesising financial and operational data to support decision-making and cross-team coordination.
- Gained practical exposure to internal controls, reporting cycles and how financial information drives decisions in a large transport organisation.

EDUCATION

BASc Interdisciplinary Problems & Methods | London Interdisciplinary School (LIS) | Expected June 2026

Problem-centred degree focused on real-world, ill-defined challenges rather than a single academic discipline. Trained in qualitative and quantitative methods including systems mapping, mixed-methods research design, thematic analysis, Python-based data analysis and statistical reasoning. Coursework spanning finance, psychology, applied AI/data, design methods and sustainability, with emphasis on decision-making under uncertainty.

Didcot Sixth Form | A-levels: Product Design (A*), Maths (B), Physics (B); Extended Project Qualification (A)

St Birinus Boys School | 10 GCSEs, A*-A

SELECTED PROJECTS

Circular Economy Strategy for Sipsmith Gin | London Interdisciplinary School, Group Project

- Produced a client-ready consultancy report exploring how Sipsmith Gin could reuse botanical by-products and production waste through circular economy partnerships.
- Mapped the production process, researched reuse pathways and helped turn a broad sustainability challenge into practical recommendations.
- Balanced environmental impact, operational feasibility, partnership potential and commercial value when prioritising recommendations.

Capstone - Designing Awe & Perspective Shifts | In progress

- Designing and leading a mixed-methods study exploring whether experiences of cosmic scale can create awe, perspective shifts and changes in wellbeing.
- Responsible for research design, quantitative and qualitative measurement, and interpretation under uncertainty.
- Applying experimental design and statistical reasoning while accounting for bias, control variables and limits around causation.

NLP & Sentiment Analysis of News Headlines | Python

- Built a Python NLP pipeline comparing financial and world news headlines, using web scraping, text cleaning, tokenisation, lemmatisation and labelled datasets.
- Improved data quality by removing duplicate scraped headlines and adapting preprocessing to preserve important context such as abbreviations.
- Used sentiment analysis and visualisation to compare emotional tone, then interpreted outputs critically in light of model limitations and media context.

Product & Materials Trade-off Modelling | GRANTA EduPack / Design Methods

- Analysed material options for children's swimming goggle lenses by translating product needs into measurable criteria including transparency, toughness, UV durability and cost.
- Used GRANTA EduPack to compare candidate materials across performance, sustainability, recyclability and likely product lifespan.
- Balanced safety, affordability, environmental impact and manufacturing practicality when evaluating material choices.

SKILLS

- Commercial & Business Development: pricing judgement, opportunity spotting, market timing, negotiation, buyer behaviour, customer discovery, partnership mapping, stakeholder engagement, process improvement, consultancy-style reporting
- Research, Analysis & Systems Thinking: systems mapping, mixed-methods research, semi-structured interviewing, qualitative synthesis, experimental design, statistical reasoning, regression, NLP/sentiment analysis, trade-off modelling, sustainability assessment
- Tools & Technical: Python, pandas, Beautiful Soup, statsmodels, data visualisation, Excel, GRANTA EduPack, GitHub, VS Code, AI-assisted workflows
- People & Communication: training and coaching, adapting communication to different audiences, stakeholder communication, building trust under pressure, evidence-based storytelling, translating complex findings into practical recommendations